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Overcome of Grief through Christ

A quaint yet familiar surrounding fades in as he takes focus. It is and reminds him of his childhood school where everything was simple. Many students happily chatting away while waiting in the line for lunch—how some may cry because they got a bad score since it was quiz week, or someone picked on them. He was sat at an empty lunch table. Then a familiar yet seemingly new figure appears beside him.

“Hey, what are you doing here alone?”

The figure startled him. Was he going to pick on him for money?

“No one should eat alone, come eat with us!”

That was surprising, the figure seemed rebellious. The figure was dressed in a normal uniform yet messy unlike him. He had dyed, blonde hair which slowly transitioned into his natural hair color, brown. His hair was also quite messy and overgrown. He seemed a year older than him, as he remembered. He couldn't quite picture his face, he wondered why.

“It's alright, I'm quite content with where I am sitting. Maybe next time,” He reluctantly declined as he sighed. “Haha, then I'll see you tomorrow! My table is there.” He waves as he points and walks to a table with two other friends. They seem quite cool. He stopped walking and turned back, “What's your name? Mine is Bryce!”

“Oliver,” Oliver answered politely, watching the figure stop.

“Well then, Oliver, I hope we get along well!” Bryce replied while testing the other’s name with his tongue with a smile. A flashback of him being the same figure leaving him gets him startled awake.

A nightmare of Bryce again. Why was he so hung up over this? It happened in middle school—that was years ago! He’s close to finishing school, he needs to graduate while not having grief take over him right after. He checked his watch and it was 1:43 a.m. The number seemed familiar, maybe to a game he once played? It was no big deal, really, actually he should be asleep now, he thought as he picked up his phone for any new messages.

Apparently there was one from his younger cousin! “Hi, so I think I’m coming at like tomorrow or something yaya see you liver this summer break!!!!!!” Oliver reacted a thumbs up to her message. Maybe she might be concerned about him reacting to it at 2 in the morning. He was tired anyway, so he's going back to bed.

As he closed the phone screen he saw himself. He did not look well, his black hair grown out and messy, faint dark circles under his eyes. He used to be so lively and happy before all that happened. Actually he shouldn’t dwell on this, he should instead look forward to seeing her tomorrow! It’s been years since he saw her, I wonder how tall she is now?

He closed his eyes and those familiar, quaint surroundings came back, meant to feel welcoming but instead he felt suffocated. A familiar voice came.

“Can’t believe this semester we get to be in the same class! We’re next to each other too and we’re at the back! This must be a dream.” Bryce exclaimed as they both talked and walked to the cafeteria.

“I’m glad too, honestly. You’re a great friend.” Oliver complimented him.

Bryce gasped dramatically, “Don’t get too sentimental on me! Plus, I’m sure you’ll say the same to my friends. Haven’t met them did ya?”

Oliver shook his head, "I hope they're as great as you speak of them," He chuckled.

They enter the cafeteria and a boy and a girl immediately welcome them, or Bryce perhaps since they had all their attention on him. He heard something about how the girl was the boy's sister, he didn't remember much. The three of them walk to their usual spot while Oliver walks uneasily behind them like a lost sheep.

Bryce introduced everyone to each other, then they laughed and talked about how the classes went. At least they all agreed it was quite boring. After he ate, Oliver pulled out his Bible and read the book of Proverbs so that he could have guidance from God which was how he should deal with them and be a witness since it did not seem they believed in Him.

He noticed the topic slowly migrated to something similar to religion which was perfect! He knew that God wanted to use him, "Speaking of that, have you all heard of the Lord?"

The three of them looked at each other and shook their heads, Bryce asking who?

"The Lord is our Creator and sacrificed His only Son for our sins." He couldn't quite remember what he said, so it transitioned to just noise. But he knew the three believed in him and the three wanted to go to church with them.

Months passed and Bryce and Oliver were the best of friends until Bryce stopped going to church. "What's up? Are you alright? You stopped going to church." Oliver approached Bryce where he was sulking.

Bryce's eyes welled up in tears and ran, Oliver chasing after him. "Bryce?!"

A shouting noise stained with tears, he could not make out, plus the running figure fading away along with the surroundings was the only noise and vision he heard and saw before he woke up.

Dazzling rays of sunlight came through the edges of the covered up window. Another day to sulk in here, he thought as a sudden, bright voice entered his room. It was inaudible, I mean, give him some time to properly wake up! He rolled over on the bed to see his younger cousin, as bright as always and actually was not that short as he remembered her!

“Hello Liver and- woah..” The girl took focus of the room and Oliver sprawled on the bed, “What happened to you?!” She sat on the edge of the bed with a worried look.

Blossom was similar to how he remembered her, with her black hair braided into one. She always looked like a ball of sunshine despite that; so cheerful and unaware of the world’s worries. Now she seemed more aware probably, because she found the Lord while he tripped on his path and is back to square one.

“Something happened. Mind if I explain?” He sat up, groaning, “Why’d you come so early though?”

Blossom watched Oliver groan as he sat up like an old man, giggling, “Oh, I just wanted to see you fast! But sure, I don’t mind because it seems that something is weighing you down. Why didn’t you message me anything though?” He told Blossom what were the problems he had and how his heart was troubled. It was how a certain situation between his childhood best friend weighed on him for years and he could not get over it.

“I feel you, that’s actually what happened but with my grandmother, though she has passed,” Blossom sighed, “I grieved for a week or more since I felt that I did not spend enough time with my grandmother before she passed, and did not become a witness to her while you did because I sadly had not found the Lord yet.”

“But now I have found the Lord and was able to overcome her death. I know you once believed in Christ and now you have strayed from Him, but it’s always okay to try again. There are many verses that comfort people who may have the same situation as you, like Psalm 34:18,” She said as she pulled out her Bible. ““The Lord is nigh unto them that are of a

broken heart....’ And there’s some more verses like from the Revelations! ‘And God shall wipe away all tears from their eyes; and there shall be no more death, neither sorrow, nor crying, neither shall there be any more pain: for the former things are passed away.’” Blossom read cheerfully.

“Do you think God will forgive me after straying from him after so-”

“Yes He will!” Blossom interrupted.

“I guess it’s worth a shot,” Oliver huffed, “But first I really need to take a shower, I just woke up!” “Ah right, sorry for intruding into your home early! You and your mom were always morning people so I thought you two would be awake!” Blossom reasoned, probably guilty, “I hope I moved your heart, Oliver!”

Oliver took his changing clothes and smiled as he headed to the bathroom, “I truly was moved, and now that I am back on track, I’m sure this week will be pleasant with you! Though, I wonder how you got in the house in the first place.”

Blossom giggled happily watching him go, “Looks like Auntie hasn’t changed one bit, she’s still a morning person. And I’m sure this week will be great for me as well, Liver!”

“I told you to stop using that nickname!”

“You didn’t say anything when I called you that in my message!”